1029: Margaritifera margaritifera

Relevant synonyms	—
Norwegian name	Elvemusling, elveperlemusling
Feature group	Insects and molluscs
Expert(s)	Jon Hamner Magerøy
Date	2026-01-05

Alpine (ALP)

Occurrence status Present regularly (PRE)

- The species is actively present in the lower parts of the Alpine BGR in Norway.

Overall conclusion	🟡 **Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)**	➡️ **Stable**
Range	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	➡️ Stable
Population	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	↘️ Deteriorating
Habitat for species	🟢 Favourable (FV)	↗️ Improving
Future prospects	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	

Arctic (ARC)

Occurrence status	Present regularly (PRE)	
Overall conclusion	🟡 **Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)**	↗️ **Improving**
Range	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	➡️ Stable
Population	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	↗️ Improving
Habitat for species	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	↗️ Improving
Future prospects	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	

Atlantic (ATL)

Occurrence status	Present regularly (PRE)	
Overall conclusion	🔴 **Unfavourable - bad (U2)**	↘️ **Deteriorating**
Range	🔴 Unfavourable - bad (U2)	➡️ Stable
Population	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	↘️ Deteriorating
Habitat for species	🟢 Favourable (FV)	➡️ Stable
Future prospects	🔴 Unfavourable - bad (U2)	

Boreal (BOR)

Occurrence status	Present regularly (PRE)	
Overall conclusion	🔴 **Unfavourable - bad (U2)**	↘️ **Deteriorating**
Range	🔴 Unfavourable - bad (U2)	➡️ Stable
Population	🟡 Unfavourable - inadequate (U1)	↘️ Deteriorating
Habitat for species	🟢 Favourable (FV)	➡️ Stable
Future prospects	🔴 Unfavourable - bad (U2)	

Pressures

- PA07: Intensive grazing or overgrazing by livestock [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- PA11: Soil management practices in agriculture (e.g. ploughing) [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PA13: Application of natural or synthetic fertilisers on agricultural land [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PA17: Agricultural activities generating pollution to surface or ground waters (including marine) [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PA20: Live stock farming generating pollution [ALP]
- PA21: Active abstraction of water for agriculture [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- PB06: Logging or thinning (excluding clear cutting) [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PB09: Clear-cutting, removal of all trees [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- PB15: Wood transport [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- PB23: Physical alteration of water bodies for forestry (including dams) [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PB24: Drainage for forestry [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- PD02: Hydropower (dams, weirs, run-off-the-river and respective infrastructure) [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- PE01: Roads, paths, railroads and related infrastructure [ALP]
- PE05: Land, water and air transport activities generating pollution to surface or ground waters [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PF09: Residential, commercial and industrial activities and structures generating air pollution [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PG11: Illegal shooting/killing [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PG17: Active abstraction of water bodies for aquaculture [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- PH01: Military, paramilitary or police exercises and operations on land and freshwater [ARC]
- PI01: Invasive alien species of Bern Convention concern [ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PI02: Other invasive alien species (other than species of Bern Convention concern) [ATL, BOR]
- PI04: Plant and animal diseases, pathogens and pests [ATL, BOR]
- PJ01: Temperature changes and extremes due to climate change [ATL, BOR]
- PJ03: Changes in precipitation regimes due to climate change [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- PJ10: Change of habitat location, size, and / or quality due to climate change [ATL, BOR]
- PX01: Threats and pressures from outside the Bern Convention geographical scope [ARC]
- PX02: Threats and pressures from outside the country [ARC]

Conservation measures

- MA01: Prevent conversion of natural and semi-natural habitats, and habitats of species into agricultural land [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- MA06: Stop mowing, grazing and other equivalent agricultural activities e.g. burning (incl. restore or improve habitats) [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- MA08: Adapt soil management practices in agriculture [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- MA09: Manage the use of natural and synthetic fertilisers as well as chemicals in agricultural for plant and animal production [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]

- MA10: Reduce/eliminate point or diffuse source pollution to surface or ground waters (including marine) from agricultural activities [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- MA13: Manage agricultural drainage and water abstraction (incl. the restoration of drained or hydrologically altered habitats) [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- MB05: Adapt/change forest management and exploitation practices [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- MB06: Stop forest management and exploitation practices [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- MB07: Measures to combat illegal logging [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- MB08: Restoration of forest habitats listed in Resolution No. 4 (1996) (incl. re-establish and improvement) [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- MB10: Reduce diffuse or point source pollution to surface or ground waters (incl. marine) from forestry activities [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- MC01: Adapt/manage extraction of non-energy resources [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- MC04: Reduce impact of hydropower operation and infrastructure (incl. the restoration of freshwater habitats) [ALP, ATL, BOR]
- MF05: Reduce/eliminate air pollution from industrial, commercial, residential and recreational areas and activities [ARC]
- MG01: Management of professional/commercial fishing, shellfish and seaweed harvesting (incl. restoration of habitats) [ARC]
- MG02: Management of hunting, recreational fishing, and the recreational or commercial harvesting or collection of plants and fungi (incl. restoration of habitats) [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- MG10: Manage water abstraction and modification of hydrological conditions for marine and freshwater aquaculture [ATL, BOR]
- MH01: Reduce impact of military installations and activities [ARC]
- MH02: Adapt/maintain military activities [ARC]
- MI02: Management, control or eradication of established invasive alien species of Bern Convention concern [ARC, ATL, BOR]
- MI03: Management, control or eradication of other invasive alien species [ATL, BOR]
- MI06: Controlling and eradicating plant and animal diseases, pathogens and pests [ATL, BOR]
- MS01: Reinforce populations of species from the Resolution No. 6 (1998) [ATL, BOR]
- MS04: Manage native species (incl. species which are not protected by the Bern Convention / Resolution No. 6 (1998)) [ALP, ARC, ATL, BOR]
- MX01: Support conservation measures in another country. [ARC]
- MX02: Support conservation measures in countries outside the geographical scope of the Bern Convention [ARC]

Data sources, references

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- Larsen, B.M. & Magerøy, J.M. 2019, Elvemuslinglokaliteter i Norge. En beskrivelse av status som grunnlag for arbeid med kartlegging og tiltak i handlingsplanen for 2019–2028. NINA Rapport 1669. Norsk institutt for naturforskning. http:/hdl.handle.net/11250/2596832
- Larsen, B.M. 2018. Handlingsplan for elvemusling (Margaritifera margaritifera L.) 2019-2028. Miljødirektoratet Rapport M 1107|2018. https:/www.miljodirektoratet.no/publikasjoner/2018/november-2018/handlingsplan-for-elvemusling-margaritifera-margaritifera-l.-2019-2028
- Magerøy, J.H., Larsen, B.M., Kivle, D.N., Johansen, K.N & Gerdenics, L. Upublisert materiale. NINAs interne database for elvemusling.
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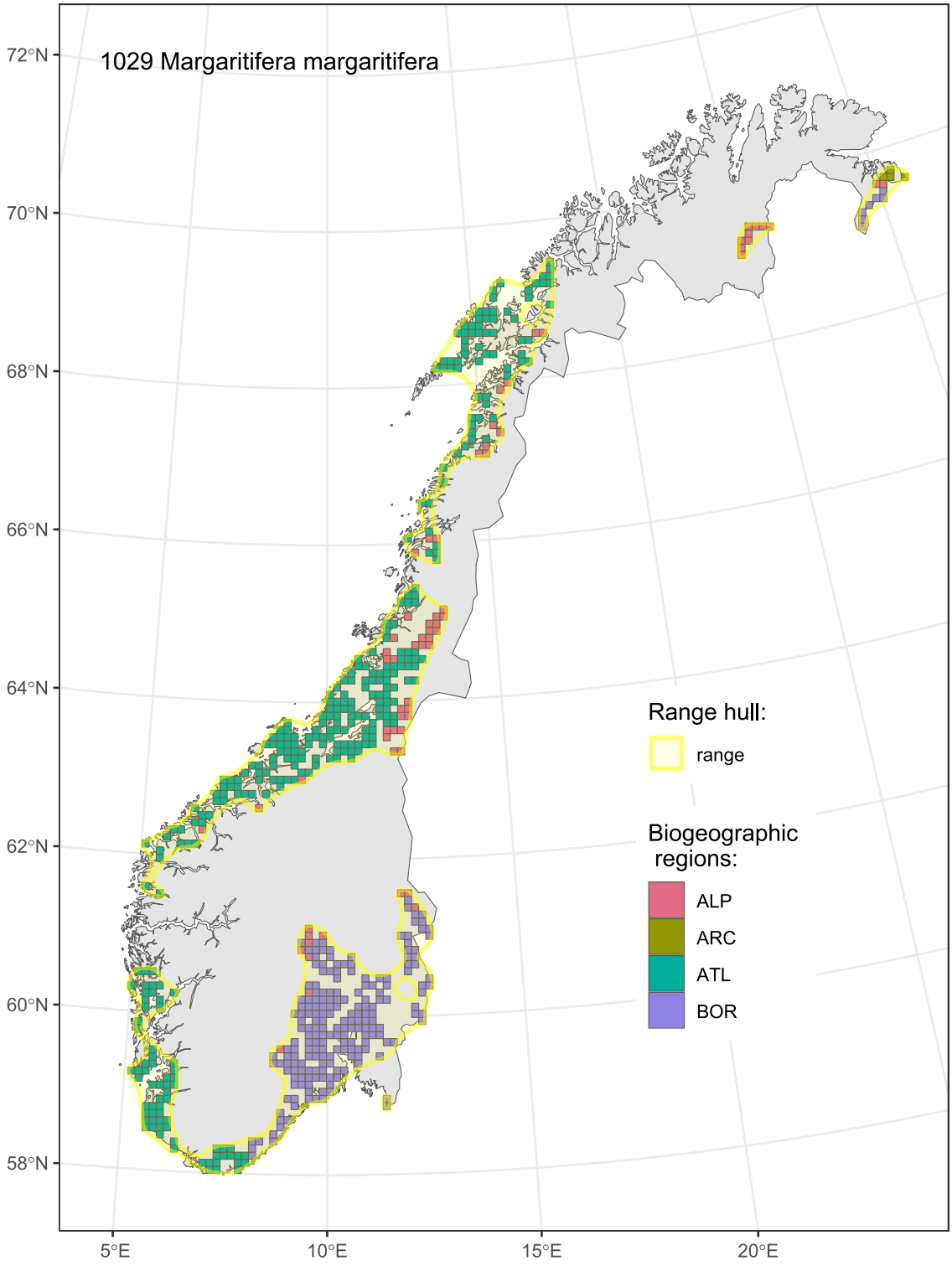
- Magerøy, J.H. & Larsen, B.M. Upublised material. Overview of threats to and conservation measures for the freshwater pearl mussel (Magaritifera margaritifera) in Norway. In: Morkens et al. Unpublished material. Overview of threats to and conservation measures for freshwater mussels in Europe.



The map is based on the national monitoring programme for Margaritifera margaritifera and its database, which provides a relatively accurate overview of the occurrences of this species in Norway.